

Combat Log — The Widow Fen

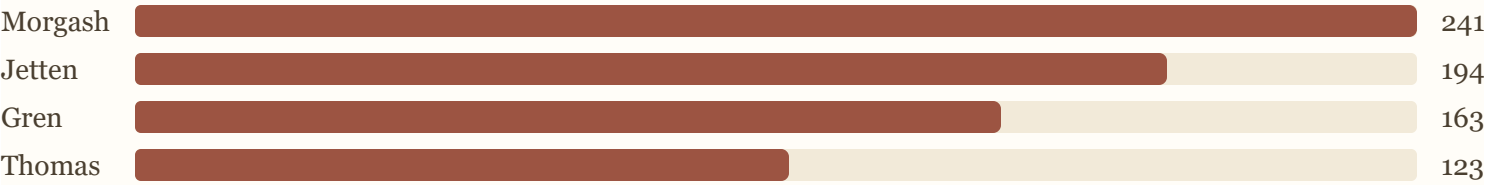
31 August 2026 · 7 combats · folded from 170 Battle Flow stamped messages of 608

Seven fights: one long swamp battle, five one-round scraps in the treetop village, and a two-round boss fight in the cavern. The party dealt **721** damage and took **219**. Two went down, both in the swamp, both to the same spell.

The headline: one creature did 90% of the damage to the party. The Enthralled Bullywug Bog Sage's *Vitriolic Sphere* accounted for **198 of the 219** points the party lost all night. Everything else in the fen — four warriors, two hags, and nine pieces of animated furniture — managed 21 between them.

1 • Headline numbers

Damage dealt, all combats



Morgash led on volume — 24 hits across the night, all weapon damage. Gren led on burst: 116 of his 163 came from two spells in the cavern.

Damage taken, all combats



Remarkably even — because the damage that mattered was one area-of-effect spell that hit everybody at once, twice.

CHARACTER	DEALT	TAKEN	HEALED OTHERS	NAT 20S	NAT 1S
Morgash the Gravemaker	241	53	12	3	1
Jetten Elisedil	194	62	10	1	2
Gren Greenmantle	163	45	8	1	1
Thomas A. Invictus	123	59	25	1	0

2 • The swamp — 01 Swamp, 3 rounds

The Bog Sage cast *Vitriolic Sphere* (4th level, 10d4 acid on impact plus 5d4 at the end of its next turn, 20-foot radius) onto the clustered party. All four failed the DC 13 Dexterity save; Gren burned Heroic Inspiration on the reroll and failed again. The lingering acid ticked a second time and dropped **Thomas** and **Jetten**.

COMBATANT	DEALT	PER ROUND	ACCURACY	TAKEN
Enthralled Bullywug Bog Sage	198	66.0	—	54
Morgash	93	31.0	7/10 · 70%	53
Thomas	47	15.7	4/4 · 100%	59
Jetten	46	15.3	3/3 · 100%	39
Gren	21	7.0	—	39
Bullywug Warriors (×4, combined)	34	11.3	4/10 · 40%	195

Death saves: Thomas 0 made / 1 failed · Jetten 1 made / 0 failed. **Recovery:** Jetten's *Healing Word* on Thomas, Thomas's *Lay on Hands* on Gren, Gren's wand missiles killing the Sage, Thomas's *Divine Smite* on the last warrior. Then *Rope Trick* for a safe short rest, with Thomas's Healer feat adding +3 per hit die spent, party-wide.

This was terrible luck, not a broken encounter. Three of the four were under *Bless* at the time, and the save was only DC 13. Working the odds back from the sheets: Morgash had a coin-flip, Thomas a shade better than one, Gren — the only one without the *Bless* die, having cast it on everyone but himself — was at 55%. And **Jetten, with a +7 Dexterity save and a Bless die on top, had roughly a seven-in-eight chance of shrugging it off.**

All four failing at once lands at **a little over one percent — on the order of a one-in-ninety night.** Then Gren spent Heroic Inspiration on the reroll and came up 9 against a 13. The sphere even killed one of the caster's own warriors. On any ordinary set of rolls two of them shrug it off, nobody goes down, and this reads as a hard opening fight rather than a near-wipe.

3 • The treetop romp — 02 Treetop, five 1-round fights

Exactly what the plan wanted: quick, clean, no attrition. Five separate combats, **every one ended in round 1.** The house guards and furniture landed a single blow all told — six damage, on Gren.

#	OPPOSITION	PARTY DAMAGE	ENEMY DAMAGE
1	Bullywug Warrior ×2	90	0

#	OPPOSITION	PARTY DAMAGE	ENEMY DAMAGE
2	Animated Broom + Rug of Smothering	46	0
3	Animated Flying Sword + Broom	42	0
4	Animated Rug of Smothering	30	0
5	Animated Broom + Flying Sword	33	6

Jetten fought in all five and was the only PC to score in fight 4 (30 damage, 3/3). Morgash's *Riposte* got baited twice by the same warrior in fight 1. Gren whiffed his only attack in three straight fights before landing a critical *Sorcerous Burst* that snapped the flying sword in half.

4 • The cavern — 03 Cavern, 2 rounds

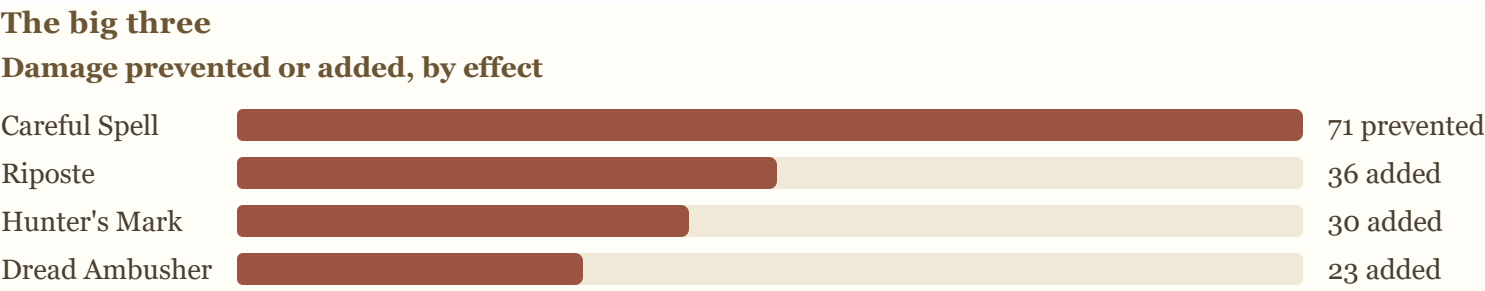
Both hags were at 86 hit points. They took 86 and 100 respectively and the fight ended in round two, having dealt 23 damage between them.

COMBATANT	DEALT	PER ROUND	ACCURACY	TAKEN
Gren (all fire)	116	58.0	—	0
Morgash (all bludgeoning)	77	38.5	5/7 • 71%	0
Jetten	52	26.0	3/6 • 50%	23
Thomas	28	14.0	2/2 • 100%	0
Hazel	23	11.5	2/2 • 100%	86
Mabel	0	0.0	0/1 • 0%	100

- **Gren's night.** *Innate Sorcery* plus *Font of Magic*, a 3rd- and a 2nd-level slot (5 levels burned), 116 fire damage — over half the party's output in the fight. His *Careful Spell* Fireball excluded every ally.
- **Morgash toppled four times** in two rounds and hit with 5 of 7.
- **Jetten passed all four saves** and held concentration three times. Hazel made 4 of 5 saves and held concentration three times before dying.
- The three animated servants each took 29 and failed their save — one Fireball swept the lot.

5 • What the buffs and features actually bought

Every spell, maneuver and mastery that touched a number this session, and what it produced. Ranked by how much it moved the fight.



- **Careful Spell was the single best resource spend of the night.** For one sorcery point, Gren's Fireball excluded all four allies from a blast that would otherwise have caught every one of them. Thomas *failed* his save outright and would have eaten the full 29; Gren, Jetten and Morgash all saved and would have taken 14 apiece. **One sorcery point prevented 71 damage** — a third of everything the party lost all session — while still landing full damage on four enemies.
- **Riposte turned two enemy misses into 36 damage.** Morgash spent two superiority dice on reaction attacks; both hit, one for 16 in the swamp and one for 20 in the treetop (which also knocked the target prone). That is a full extra turn's output taken on somebody else's initiative.
- **Hunter's Mark carried 30 force damage** across four separate fights — about one sixth of Jetten's total output — and he kept moving it to new targets with a bonus action rather than recasting, so it cost him exactly one spell slot all night. *Dread Ambusher* added another 23 psychic on top.

EFFECT	USES	WHAT IT PRODUCED
Topple (Maul of Momentum)	14	12 knocked prone, 2 resisted — an 86% hit rate, each one handing the next melee attacker advantage
Sap (First Light)	8	Disadvantage imposed on the target's next attack, eight times
Precision Attack	5	3 misses converted into hits ; 2 dice spent and still missed
Great Weapon Master — Hew	5	Five free bonus-action attacks, off four kills and one critical hit
Riposte	2	Both hit — 36 damage on reactions
Vex (shortsword)	2	Advantage carried into Jetten's following attack
Shield Master — bash	4	One knockdown landed, three saved against. Offered seven times — Thomas took it up on four
Action Surge	2	Extra actions in both major fights — the cavern one produced the critical hit on Mabel

Buffs, and what they were worth

buff	cost	return
Careful Spell	1 sorcery point	71 damage prevented — best value of the night by a wide margin
Pass without Trace	2nd-level slot	+10 on four Stealth rolls. Three cleared the guard's roll comfortably; Morgash's failed even with it (a 2 on disadvantage, in splint armour) and gave the party away
Bless (Fey-Touched)	free cast	Exactly one flip all night — a d4 of 2 turning one of Morgash's misses into a hit. It also added its die to three of the four Vitriolic Sphere saves, and all three still failed. The concentration broke to that same spell moments later
Spellfire Burst	rider on Fireball	1d4 rolled a 4 — exactly the Animated Armor's last 4 hit points
Aid	2nd-level slot	+5 max HP each to Morgash, Jetten and Thomas. The treetop then cost the party six damage total, so the 15-point buffer went almost entirely unused — only Jetten dipped into it, in the cavern. Still running for another few hours
Innate Sorcery	1 of 2 uses	Raised Gren's spell save DC from 15 to 16 — and changed no outcome : every creature that failed the Fireball would have failed at 15, and everyone who saved would still have saved
Heroic Inspiration	1 use	Reroll on the Vitriolic Sphere save: 5 became 9, against a 13. Wasted
Tactical Mind	2 Second Wind uses	Both spent on checks that failed anyway; one was rewound at the table when the cost was pointed out

Healing that mattered

Three separate raises from zero hit points, all in the swamp: **Jetten's Healing Word** put Thomas back on his feet, **Gren's Healing Word** did it again after the lingering acid dropped him a second time, and **Morgash's Potion of Healing** brought Jetten back. Thomas's *Lay on Hands* put 10 into Gren before any of that.

The *Rope Trick* short rest was the real recovery, though — and Thomas's **Healer** feat quietly doubled it, adding **+3 hit points per hit die** to every roll the party made. Between them the party spent most of its hit dice and walked into the treetop at or near full, which is the only reason the second half of the session was comfortable.

6 • Combat flow — decision speed

The new timing stamps, averaged per player across timed decision moments.

character	avg decision	timed moments	slowest call
Jetten Elisedil	8.4s	8	24.0s — mastery

CHARACTER	AVG DECISION	TIMED MOMENTS	SLOWEST CALL
Morgash the Gravemaker	8.6s	22	24.0s — mastery
Thomas A. Invictus	17.7s	7	24.0s — bash offer
Gren Greenmantle	19.4s	5	24.0s — hold

Morgash generated **22 timed moments** — nearly as many as the other three combined (20) — and still averaged the second-fastest decisions. The martial kit is being used, and used quickly.

7 • Economy and flavour

Resources spent

- **Morgash** — Second Wind down to 1/3, Combat Superiority to 1/4, Action Surge used in both major fights.
- **Gren** — Innate Sorcery 1/2, Font of Magic 1/5, wand at 2/7 charges, both Fey-Touched casts spent.
- **Jetten** — Dreadful Strike 1/3, *Pass without Trace* used, all 2nd-level slots gone.
- **Thomas** — three 1st-level and two 2nd-level slots.

The night's dice

- **Buff-die flip:** exactly one all night. Morgash rolled 16 against a Bullywug Warrior's AC 16 — the +2 from Bless turned that miss into a hit.
- **Natural 20s:** Morgash ×3, and one each for Gren, Thomas, Jetten — and one for Mabel.
- **Natural 1s:** Jetten ×2, plus one each for Morgash, Gren and Mabel, and four among the monsters.
- **Advantage rolled:** Thomas ×4, Gren ×3, Morgash ×3, Jetten ×1. Disadvantage: one each for Morgash, Thomas and Jetten.
- **Death saves:** Thomas 0 made / 1 failed; Jetten 1 made / 0 failed.